Sales Growth and Operating Profitability of Internet-Origin and Store-Origin Retailers: Amazon North America and Walmart U.S. Around the COVID-19 Pandemic, 2019-2024

Relative to a 2019 pre-pandemic baseline, how did sales growth and operating margins differ between Amazon North America and Walmart U.S. during 2020-2021 and the subsequent 2022-2024 adjustment period? This is a descriptive comparison, not an estimate of the causal effect of COVID-19.

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Research design and definitions

Amazon years ending December 31 are paired with Walmart fiscal years ending January 31 of the following year. These are approximately corresponding periods, not identical periods. Actual start and end dates must be recorded and checked in the data module.

Sales growth = (current / previous annual net sales - 1) * 100. Operating margin = segment operating income / segment net sales * 100. Sales index = current / base-year net sales * 100. Percent values are already multiplied by 100. First study-year growth is unavailable and is shown as NA, not zero.

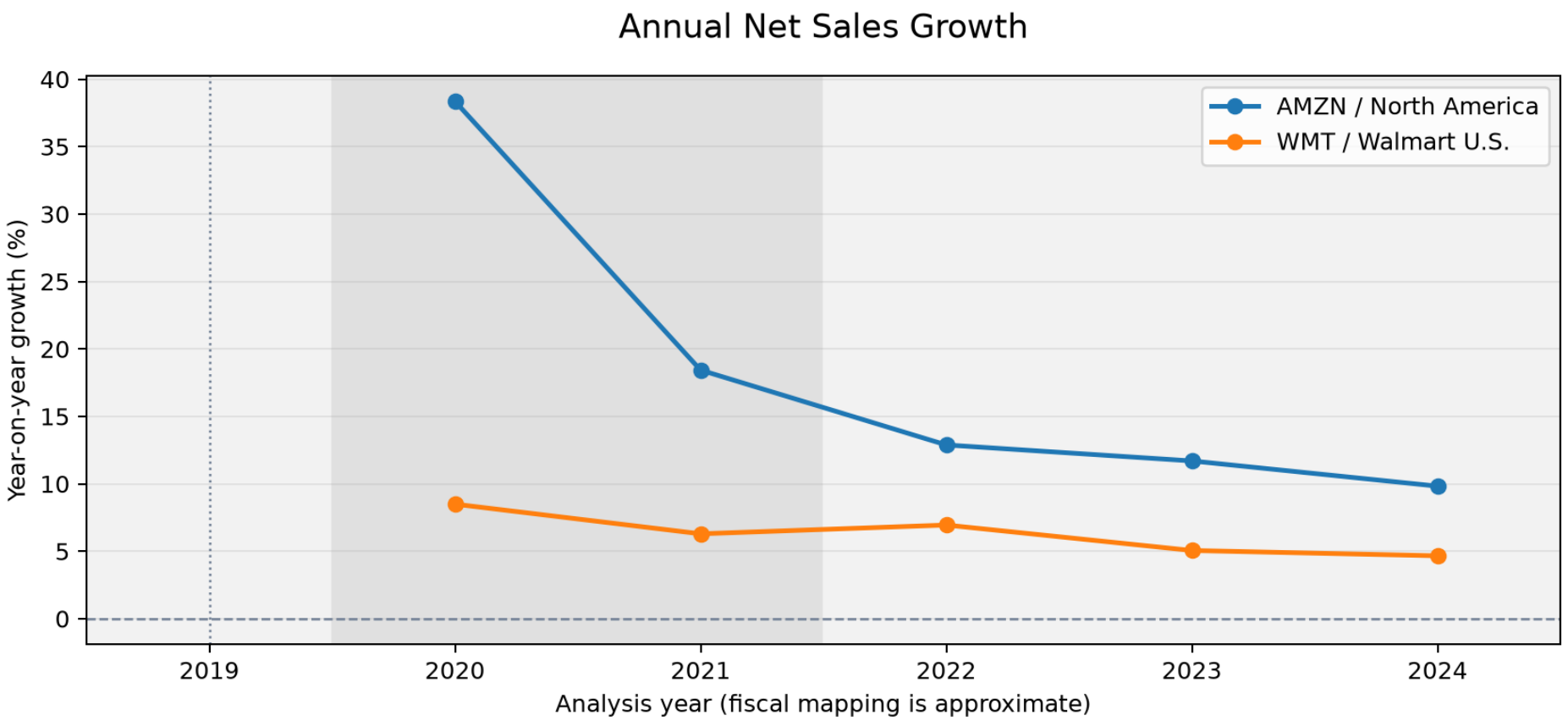
The configured reference year is 2019. Sales changes from that year are percentages; margin changes are percentage points. These cumulative sales changes are not CAGR.

Observed results

- Amazon.com, Inc. / North America: net sales in analysis year 2024 were 387,497 USD millions. Sales changed by +126.91% relative to 2019. Operating margin was 6.44%, a change of +2.32 percentage points from the base year. The lowest observed annual margin was -0.90% in analysis year 2022.

- Walmart Inc. / Walmart U.S.: net sales in analysis year 2024 were 462,415 USD millions. Sales changed by +35.60% relative to 2019. Operating margin was 5.16%, a change of +0.07 percentage points from the base year. The lowest observed annual margin was 4.90% in analysis year 2022.

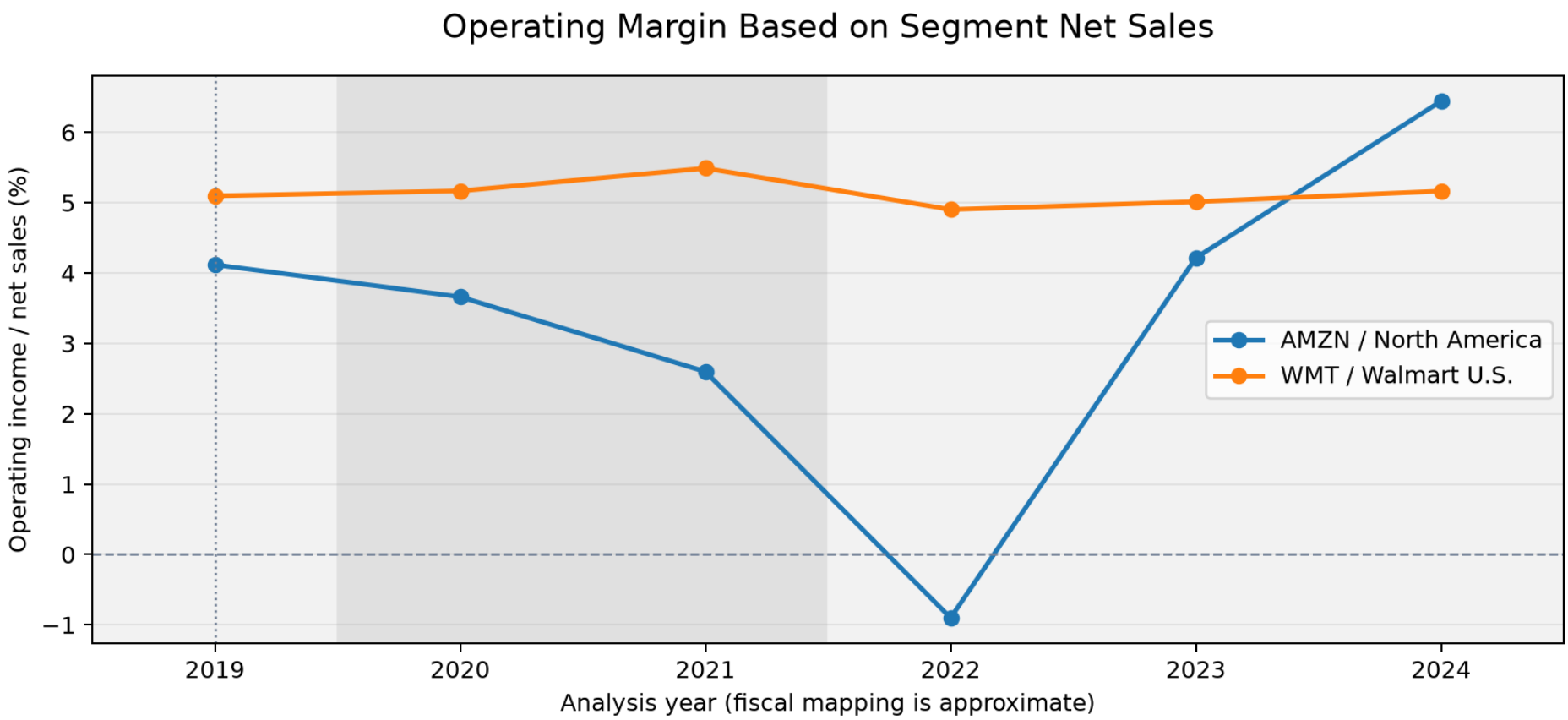
Annual comparison charts



Stage shading: Pre-pandemic baseline: 2019 | Pandemic disruption: 2020, 2021 | Subsequent adjustment: 2022, 2023, 2024. Dotted line: base year 2019.
Source: adopted official filings; selected segment financial records.
Amazon years ending December 31 are paired with Walmart fiscal years ending January 31 of the following year. These are approximately corresponding periods, not identical periods. Actual start and end dates must be recorded and checked in the data module.
First study-year growth is unavailable; it is not zero.

Annual Net Sales Growth. Values come from the verified current SQLite metric results.

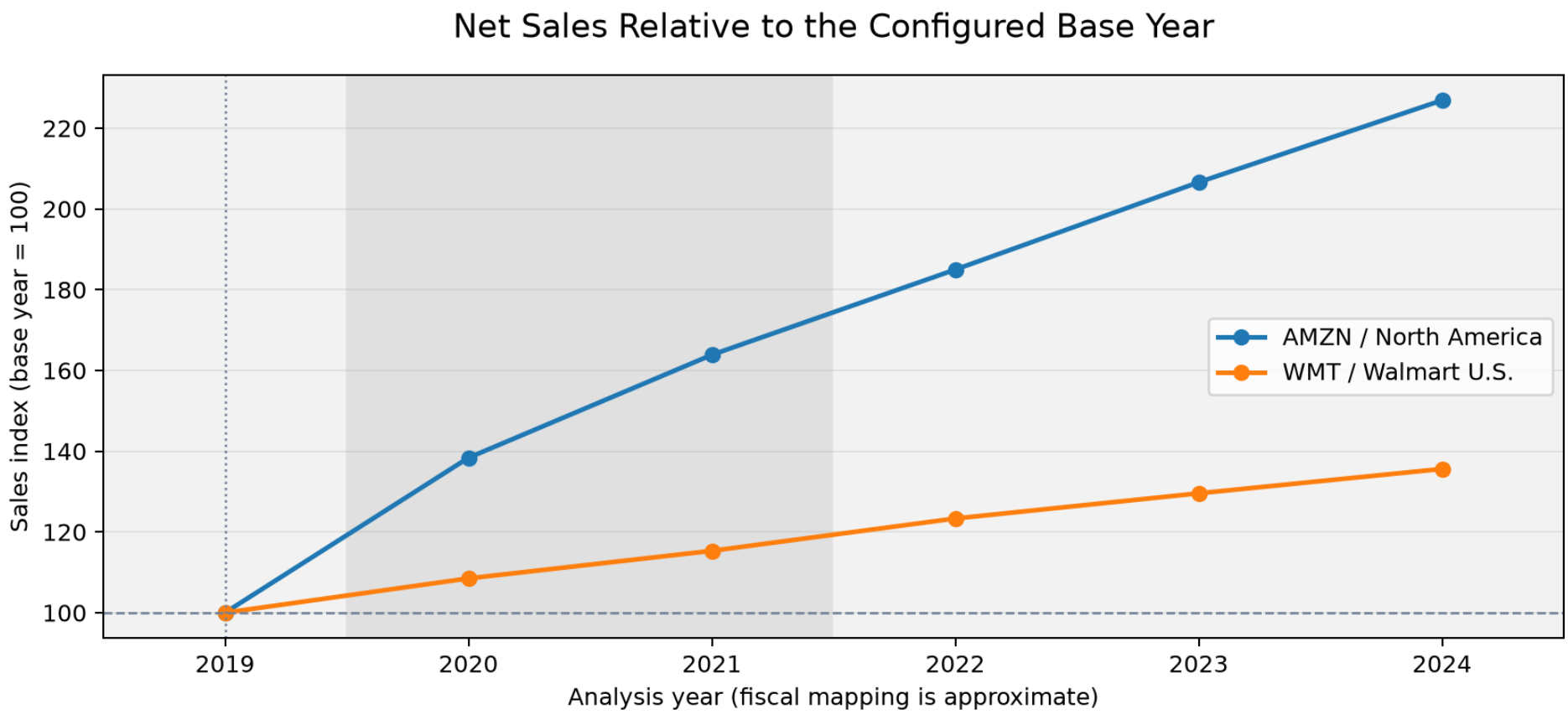
Annual comparison charts (continued)



Stage shading: Pre-pandemic baseline: 2019 | Pandemic disruption: 2020, 2021 | Subsequent adjustment: 2022, 2023, 2024. Dotted line: base year 2019.
Source: adopted official filings; selected segment financial records.
Amazon years ending December 31 are paired with Walmart fiscal years ending January 31 of the following year. These are approximately corresponding periods, not identical periods. Actual start and end dates must be recorded and checked in the data module.

Operating Margin Based on Segment Net Sales. Values come from the verified current SQLite metric results.

Annual comparison charts (continued)



Stage shading: Pre-pandemic baseline: 2019 | Pandemic disruption: 2020, 2021 | Subsequent adjustment: 2022, 2023, 2024. Dotted line: base year 2019.
Source: adopted official filings; selected segment financial records.
Amazon years ending December 31 are paired with Walmart fiscal years ending January 31 of the following year. These are approximately corresponding periods, not identical periods. Actual start and end dates must be recorded and checked in the data module.

Net Sales Relative to the Configured Base Year. Values come from the verified current SQLite metric results.

Annual values

Company	Segment	Analysis year	Reported fiscal year	Study stage	Net sales (USD millions)	Operating income (USD millions)	Sales growth (%)	Operating margin (%)	Sales index
Amazon.com, Inc.	North America	2019	2019	Pre-pandemic baseline	170,773.00	7,033.00	NA	4.12	100.00
Amazon.com, Inc.	North America	2020	2020	Pandemic disruption	236,282.00	8,651.00	38.36	3.66	138.36
Amazon.com, Inc.	North America	2021	2021	Pandemic disruption	279,833.00	7,271.00	18.43	2.60	163.86
Amazon.com, Inc.	North America	2022	2022	Subsequent adjustment	315,880.00	-2,847.00	12.88	-0.90	184.97
Amazon.com, Inc.	North America	2023	2023	Subsequent adjustment	352,828.00	14,877.00	11.70	4.22	206.61
Amazon.com, Inc.	North America	2024	2024	Subsequent adjustment	387,497.00	24,967.00	9.83	6.44	226.91
Walmart Inc.	Walmart U.S.	2019	2020	Pre-pandemic baseline	341,004.00	17,380.00	NA	5.10	100.00
Walmart Inc.	Walmart U.S.	2020	2021	Pandemic disruption	369,963.00	19,116.00	8.49	5.17	108.49
Walmart Inc.	Walmart U.S.	2021	2022	Pandemic disruption	393,247.00	21,587.00	6.29	5.49	115.32
Walmart Inc.	Walmart U.S.	2022	2023	Subsequent adjustment	420,553.00	20,620.00	6.94	4.90	123.33
Walmart Inc.	Walmart U.S.	2023	2024	Subsequent adjustment	441,817.00	22,154.00	5.06	5.01	129.56
Walmart Inc.	Walmart U.S.	2024	2025	Subsequent adjustment	462,415.00	23,882.00	4.66	5.16	135.60

Changes relative to the base year

Company	Segment	Analysis year	Reported fiscal year	Net sales (USD millions)	Sales change from base (%)	Operating margin (%)	Margin change from base (pp)
Amazon.com, Inc.	North America	2019	2019	170,773.00	0.00	4.12	0.00
Amazon.com, Inc.	North America	2020	2020	236,282.00	38.36	3.66	-0.46
Amazon.com, Inc.	North America	2021	2021	279,833.00	63.86	2.60	-1.52
Amazon.com, Inc.	North America	2022	2022	315,880.00	84.97	-0.90	-5.02
Amazon.com, Inc.	North America	2023	2023	352,828.00	106.61	4.22	0.10
Amazon.com, Inc.	North America	2024	2024	387,497.00	126.91	6.44	2.32
Walmart Inc.	Walmart U.S.	2019	2020	341,004.00	0.00	5.10	0.00
Walmart Inc.	Walmart U.S.	2020	2021	369,963.00	8.49	5.17	0.07
Walmart Inc.	Walmart U.S.	2021	2022	393,247.00	15.32	5.49	0.39
Walmart Inc.	Walmart U.S.	2022	2023	420,553.00	23.33	4.90	-0.19
Walmart Inc.	Walmart U.S.	2023	2024	441,817.00	29.56	5.01	-0.08
Walmart Inc.	Walmart U.S.	2024	2025	462,415.00	35.60	5.16	0.07

Stage summaries and available years

Each stage mean is an unweighted arithmetic mean of available annual values. The table reports the number of valid years for each metric. These are not pooled margins or compound growth rates. The single-year baseline is a reference, not an equal-length comparison group.

Company	Segment	Study stage	Analysis years	Annual records	Growth: valid years	Growth: annual mean (%)	Margin: valid years	Margin: annual mean (%)	Index: valid years	Index: annual mean
Amazon.com, Inc.	North America	Pre-pandemic baseline	2019	1	0	NA	1	4.12	1	100.00
Amazon.com, Inc.	North America	Pandemic disruption	2020, 2021	2	2	28.40	2	3.13	2	151.11
Amazon.com, Inc.	North America	Subsequent adjustment	2022, 2023, 2024	3	3	11.47	3	3.25	3	206.16
Walmart Inc.	Walmart U.S.	Pre-pandemic baseline	2019	1	0	NA	1	5.10	1	100.00
Walmart Inc.	Walmart U.S.	Pandemic disruption	2020, 2021	2	2	7.39	2	5.33	2	111.91
Walmart Inc.	Walmart U.S.	Subsequent adjustment	2022, 2023, 2024	3	3	5.55	3	5.03	3	129.50

Scope and limitations

- 2019 supplies a pre-pandemic reference for sales scale and operating margin.
- The 2020-2021 and 2022-2024 stages are study groupings, not estimates of pandemic effects or a claim that the pandemic ended in 2022.
- This is a small, descriptive segment comparison. One pre-pandemic year cannot establish a pre-pandemic trend or a counterfactual.
- Amazon North America includes service revenue and covers a different geography from Walmart U.S.; the segments are not identical retail businesses.
- Historical columns in the adopted official reports are used; later restatements are not automatically included.
- Changes in these financial indicators alone cannot identify the causes of the observed patterns.
- North America: Use North America segment net sales and operating income, not consolidated totals.
- North America: The segment excludes AWS but includes advertising, subscription services, and third-party seller services.
- North America: The segment's geographical scope and revenue recognition differ from Walmart U.S.
- Walmart U.S.: Use Walmart U.S. segment net sales and operating income, not consolidated totals.
- Walmart U.S.: Exclude Sam's Club and Walmart International from the selected segment data.
- Walmart U.S.: Walmart fiscal years end on January 31 of the labeled year.

Source and period audit

Company	Segment	Analysis year	Reported fiscal year	Period start	Period end	Source section and year columns	Basis for period dates	Source access date
Amazon.com, Inc.	North America	2019	2019	2019-01-01	2019-12-31	Note 10 - Segment Information; North America; fiscal 2019 column	Annual December 31 year-end in source table; January 1 start derived from annual calendar period	2026-10-10
Amazon.com, Inc.	North America	2020	2020	2020-01-01	2020-12-31	Note 10 - Segment Information; North America; fiscal 2020 column	Annual December 31 year-end in source table; January 1 start derived from annual calendar period	2026-10-10
Amazon.com, Inc.	North America	2021	2021	2021-01-01	2021-12-31	Note 10 - Segment Information; North America; fiscal 2021 column	Annual December 31 year-end in source table; January 1 start derived from annual calendar period	2026-10-10
Amazon.com, Inc.	North America	2022	2022	2022-01-01	2022-12-31	Note 10 - Segment Information; North America; fiscal 2022 column	Annual December 31 year-end in source table; January 1 start derived from annual calendar period	2026-10-10
Amazon.com, Inc.	North America	2023	2023	2023-01-01	2023-12-31	Note 10 - Segment Information; North America; fiscal 2023 column	Annual December 31 year-end in source table; January 1 start derived from annual calendar period	2026-10-10
Amazon.com, Inc.	North America	2024	2024	2024-01-01	2024-12-31	Note 10 - Segment Information; North America; fiscal 2024 column	Annual December 31 year-end in source table; January 1 start derived from annual calendar period	2026-10-10

Source and period audit (continued)

Company	Segment	Analysis year	Reported fiscal year	Period start	Period end	Source section and year columns	Basis for period dates	Source access date
Walmart Inc.	Walmart U.S.	2019	2020	2019-02-01	2020-01-31	Item 7 - MD&A; Walmart U.S. Segment; fiscal 2020 column	Annual January 31 year-end in source table and U.S. fiscal calendar; February 1 start derived from annual period	2026-10-10
Walmart Inc.	Walmart U.S.	2020	2021	2020-02-01	2021-01-31	Item 7 - MD&A; Walmart U.S. Segment; fiscal 2021 column	Annual January 31 year-end in source table and U.S. fiscal calendar; February 1 start derived from annual period	2026-10-10
Walmart Inc.	Walmart U.S.	2021	2022	2021-02-01	2022-01-31	Item 7 - MD&A; Walmart U.S. Segment; fiscal 2022 column	Annual January 31 year-end in source table and U.S. fiscal calendar; February 1 start derived from annual period	2026-10-10
Walmart Inc.	Walmart U.S.	2022	2023	2022-02-01	2023-01-31	Item 7 - MD&A; Walmart U.S. Segment; checked against segment note; fiscal 2023 column	Annual January 31 year-end in source table and U.S. fiscal calendar; February 1 start derived from annual period	2026-10-10
Walmart Inc.	Walmart U.S.	2023	2024	2023-02-01	2024-01-31	Item 7 - MD&A; Walmart U.S. Segment; checked against segment note; fiscal 2024 column	Annual January 31 year-end in source table and U.S. fiscal calendar; February 1 start derived from annual period	2026-10-10
Walmart Inc.	Walmart U.S.	2024	2025	2024-02-01	2025-01-31	Item 7 - MD&A; Walmart U.S. Segment; checked against segment note; fiscal 2025 column	Annual January 31 year-end in source table and U.S. fiscal calendar; February 1 start derived from annual period	2026-10-10

Adopted official report links

- https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1018724/000101872422000005/amzn-20211231.htm

- https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1018724/000101872425000004/amzn-20241231.htm

- https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/104169/000010416922000012/wmt-20220131.htm

- https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/104169/000010416925000021/wmt-20250131.htm

Amounts were manually transcribed from free official reports and checked in Module 02. The pipeline does not fetch new filings during reporting. Full report HTML snapshots are not bundled.